🗺️ Geography of India — Flowchart Memory Map

Rivers & Tributaries · Ports · National Parks & Animals · Mountains · Soils · Climate — drawn as trees & patterns so it registers in one glance.

Target post: ASO · Tier-I General Awareness · NCERT-level scope. Every block tagged by priority.

P1 High-yield — do first P2 Medium P3 Low / rare 🧠 = mnemonic

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📅 **2026-07-04** · **Topic of the day:** Ports — West vs East coast superlatives rotates daily

🧭 The Whole Subject in One Tree P1

Don't read it — **travel down India**. Ride this line from the snowy North to the island South; each stop is one physical division.

🧭 **NORTH · start at the Himalayas**

1 ⛰️

Himalayas P1

Young fold mountains · **snow-fed perennial rivers** (Ganga, Indus, Brahmaputra)

2 🌾

Northern Plains P1

Indo-Gangetic Plain · **alluvial = most fertile**; India's breadbasket

3 ▯

Peninsular Plateau P1

Oldest land · **black soil** · rain-fed rivers (Godavari, Krishna)

4 🌵

Thar Desert P2

Rajasthan · **Luni is the only river** (ends in Rann of Kutch)

5 🏖️

Coastal Plains P2

West = Konkan/Malabar · East = **Coromandel** (deltas of the big rivers)

6 🌴

Islands P3

Andaman & Nicobar (Bay of Bengal) · **Lakshadweep** (Arabian Sea)

🧠 Ride the icons N→S: ⛰️🌾🏜️🌵🏖️🏝️ — "Mountain, Plain, Plateau, Desert, Coast, Islands." Top → bottom → edges.

🌊 River Systems — the Master Split P1

Rule #1: every Indian river is either **Himalayan** (perennial) or **Peninsular** (seasonal). Then it flows **East → Bay of Bengal (makes DELTA)** or **West → Arabian Sea (makes ESTUARY)**.

INDIAN RIVERS

HIMALAYAN — perennial

- **Indus** → Arabian Sea (Pakistan)
- **Ganga** → Bay of Bengal (Sundarbans delta)
- **Brahmaputra** → Bay of Bengal (joins Ganga)

PENINSULAR — rain-fed

- **East → BoB** DELTA — Godavari · Krishna · Kaveri · Mahanadi
- **West → Arab.** ESTUARY — Narmada · Tapi (rift valleys, no delta)

🧠 **Only 2 big rivers go WEST** = **"Na-Ta"** → **Na**rmada & **Ta**pi (both in rift valleys, both make estuaries). Everything else peninsular goes EAST and makes a delta.

Source → Mouth table (most-asked)

RIVER	SOURCE	ENDS IN	TAG	HOOK
Ganga	Gangotri glacier (as Bhagirathi)	Bay of Bengal (Sundarbans)	P1	Longest river *in* India; Alaknanda+Bhagirathi → **Devprayag**
Indus	Near L. Mansarovar (Tibet)	Arabian Sea	P1	Indus Water Treaty 1960
Brahmaputra	Angsi glacier (Tibet)	Bay of Bengal	P1	Tsangpo→Dihang; floods Assam (braided)
Godavari	Trimbakeshwar, Nashik (MH)	Bay of Bengal	P1	**Longest peninsular** = "Dakshin Ganga"
Krishna	Mahabaleshwar (MH)	Bay of Bengal	P2	2nd longest peninsular

RIVER	SOURCE	ENDS IN	TAG	HOOK
Kaveri	Talakaveri, Brahmagiri (KA)	Bay of Bengal	P2	"Ganga of the South"; TN–KA dispute
Narmada	Amarkantak (MP)	Arabian Sea (estuary)	P1	West-flowing, rift valley — no delta
Tapi	Multai, Satpura (MP)	Arabian Sea (estuary)	P2	Parallel & west of Narmada
Mahanadi	Sihawa (Chhattisgarh)	Bay of Bengal	P3	Hirakud Dam (longest dam)
Luni	Aravallis (Pushkar)	Rann of Kutch (saline)	P3	Only Thar river; "salt river"

Tributaries — the Trees that Trap You P1

SSC loves "X is a tributary of ___". Learn the two big trees (Ganga & Yamuna) as branches.

GANGA — tributaries

Left bank

- Ramganga
- Gomti
- Ghaghara
- Gandak
- Kosi

Right bank

- Yamuna
- Son

🧠 Left-bank G-team: **"Ram Goes Ghar Gandak Kosi"**. Kosi = **"Sorrow of Bihar"**.

YAMUNA — tributaries

Right bank

- Chambal
- Betwa
- Ken
- Sind

Left bank

- Hindon

🧠 Yamuna's right team: **"Chal Bhai Ken Sind"** → **Ch**ambal, **Bet**wa, **Ken**, **Sind**. Yamuna = **longest tributary of Ganga**.

Other high-value tributaries

TRIBUTARY	OF RIVER	NOTE	TAG
Yamuna	Ganga	Longest tributary; Chambal joins Yamuna, not Ganga directly	P1
Chambal	Yamuna	Origin Janapav (MP); ravines/badlands	P2

TRIBUTARY	OF RIVER	NOTE	TAG
Kosi	Ganga	"Sorrow of Bihar"	P1
Damodar	Hooghly (Ganga system)	"Sorrow of Bengal"; DVC controls it	P2
Tungabhadra	Krishna	Formed by Tunga + Bhadra	P2
Bhima	Krishna	Major left-bank tributary	P3
Indravati	Godavari	—	P3
Alaknanda + Bhagirathi	form Ganga	Meet at **Devprayag**; the 5 Prayags	P1

Panch Prayag (Alaknanda confluences, N→S): Vishnuprayag → Nandprayag → Karnaprayag → Rudraprayag → **Devprayag** (last one, Ganga is born here). 🧠 **"Vishnu Nand Karan Rudra Dev"**.

🐅 National Parks & Animals — match the Animal to the Park P1

Picture the **animal**, then the park lights up. Each card = big animal icon → its park → state. The 4 gold cards are the "Big 4" that repeat every year.



P1

Asiatic Lion

Gir · Gujarat

ONLY home of lions in India



P1

One-horned Rhino

Kaziranga · Assam

UNESCO World Heritage site



P1

Royal Bengal Tiger

Sundarbans · West Bengal

Mangrove delta



P1

Tiger — 1st Park

Jim Corbett · Uttarakhand

India's 1st NP (1936)



P2

Elephants

Periyar · Kerala



P2

Migratory Birds

Keoladeo · Bharatpur (Raj)

Also tigers

Siberian cranes



P3

Hangul (stag)

Dachigam · J&K

State animal of J&K



P3

Snow Leopard

Hemis · Ladakh

Largest NP in India



P2

Tiger + Rhino

Manas · Kanha · Bandhavgarh

Assam / MP

🧠 The gold "Big 4": **Gir = Lion 🦁, Kaziranga = Rhino 🦏, Sundarbans = Tiger 🐯, Corbett = 1st park 🐅.** If you remember only four, remember these — they repeat every year.

Projects: Project Tiger → **1973**; Project Elephant → **1992**. Tiger is the national animal; peacock the national bird; Ganges river dolphin the national aquatic animal.

⚓ Major Ports — West Coast vs East Coast P2

India has ~13 major ports. Trick: **list them coast-wise, top to bottom.** West coast has 6, East coast has 6, plus Port Blair (island).

WEST COAST (Arabian Sea)

Gujarat	Kandla / Deendayal — tidal port
Maharashtra	Mumbai — busiest/largest
	JNPT/Nhava Sheva — largest container
Goa	Mormugao — iron-ore export
Karnataka	New Mangalore

EAST COAST (Bay of Bengal)

West Bengal	Kolkata–Haldia — only riverine major port
Odisha	Paradip
Andhra	Visakhapatnam — deepest port
Tamil Nadu	Chennai — artificial harbour
	Ennore/Kamarajar — 1st corporate port

Kerala	Kochi (Cochin) natural harbour	Tuticorin/V.O.C.

🧠 **Superlatives worth 1 mark each:** Mumbai = busiest · JNPT = biggest container · Vizag = deepest · Kandla = tidal · Kolkata = riverine · Ennore = first corporatised.

⛰️ Mountains & Passes P2

HIMALAYAS — 3 parallel ranges (N→S)

Himadri	Greater Himalaya — highest; Everest, Kanchenjunga
Himachal	Lesser Himalaya — hill stations (Shimla, Mussoorie)
Shiwaliks	Outer Himalaya — youngest, "Duns" valleys

FACT	ANSWER	TAG
Highest peak in India	Kanchenjunga (Sikkim) · entirely-in-India: Nanda Devi	P1
Oldest fold mountains in India	Aravallis (highest: Guru Shikhar, Mt Abu)	P1
Highest peak of South India	Anamudi (Western Ghats, Kerala)	P2
Western Ghats vs Eastern Ghats	Western = continuous & higher (Sahyadri); Eastern = broken	P2
Passes	Zoji La (Ladakh), Nathu La/Jelep La (Sikkim), Rohtang/Shipki La (HP), Bomdi La (Arunachal)	P2

🧠 Himalaya N→S = **"Him-Him-Shi"** (Himadri → Himachal → Shiwalik). Aravalli = **A**ncient = oldest.

🟤 Soils of India P2

SOIL	WHERE	BEST FOR	TAG
Alluvial	Indo-Gangetic plains	Most fertile & widespread; wheat, rice (rich potash, poor N)	P1
Black (Regur)	Deccan Trap	**Cotton** ("black cotton soil"); self-ploughing	P1
Red	SE Deccan (iron oxide)	Millets, groundnut	P2
Laterite	High rain, leaching (W. Ghats)	Tea, coffee, cashew	P2
Arid/Desert	Rajasthan (saline)	Drought crops with irrigation	P3

🧠 **Black = Cotton, Alluvial = most fertile, Laterite = Tea/Coffee.** If you jam only 3 soils, jam these.

🌦️ Climate & Monsoon P2

SW Monsoon June–Sept · brings MOST rain · "burst of monsoon" · Arabian Sea + Bay of Bengal branches

NE (retreating) Oct–Dec · rains the **Tamil Nadu / Coromandel** coast

Mawsynram (Meghalaya) = highest rainfall in the world (near Cherrapunji). Tropic of Cancer (23.5°N) cuts India into ~half; Standard Meridian 82°30'E (IST = UTC+5:30).

🧠 TN gets rain in **winter** (NE monsoon) while the rest of India is dry — classic trap question.

⚡ 60-Second Rapid Revision P1

PROMPT	ANSWER
Longest river in India	Ganga
Longest peninsular river	Godavari (Dakshin Ganga)
Longest tributary of Ganga	Yamuna

PROMPT	ANSWER
West-flowing (estuary) rivers	Narmada & Tapi (rift valleys)
World's largest delta	Sundarbans (Ganga–Brahmaputra)
Sorrow of Bihar / Bengal	Kosi / Damodar
Ganga born at	Devprayag (Bhagirathi + Alaknanda)
Gir / Kaziranga / Sundarbans	Lion / Rhino / Tiger
India's 1st national park	Jim Corbett (1936)
Largest national park	Hemis (Ladakh)
Deepest / busiest port	Visakhapatnam / Mumbai
Only riverine major port	Kolkata–Haldia
Cotton soil / most fertile soil	Black (Regur) / Alluvial
Oldest fold mountains	Aravallis
Highest rainfall	Mawsynram (Meghalaya)

PYQ pattern: "Which river flows through a rift valley?" → Narmada / Tapi. · "Kaziranga is famous for?" → One-horned rhino. · "Longest tributary of the Ganga?" → Yamuna.